

Data Manipulation

Sub-techniques (3)

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Adversaries may insert, delete, or manipulate data in order to influence external outcomes or hide activity, thus threatening the integrity of the data.^[1] By manipulating data, adversaries may attempt to affect a business process, organizational understanding, or decision making.

The type of modification and the impact it will have depends on the target application and process as well as the goals and objectives of the adversary. For complex systems, an adversary would likely need special expertise and possibly access to specialized software related to the system that would typically be gained through a prolonged information gathering campaign in order to have the desired impact.

ID: T1565

Sub-techniques: [T1565.001](#), [T1565.002](#), [T1565.003](#)

① **Tactic:** [Impact](#)

① **Platforms:** Linux, Windows, macOS

① **Impact Type:** Integrity

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Procedure Examples

ID	Name	Description
G1016	FIN13	FIN13 has injected fraudulent transactions into compromised networks that mimic legitimate behavior to siphon off incremental amounts of money. ^[1]
S9014	PHASEJAM	PHASEJAM has blocked legitimate upgrades of Ivanti Connect Secure systems and falsely indicates a successful upgrade while operating on an older version. ^[2]

Mitigations

ID	Mitigation	Description
M1041	Encrypt Sensitive Information	Consider encrypting important information to reduce an adversary’s ability to perform tailored data modifications.
M1030	Network Segmentation	Identify critical business and system processes that may be targeted by adversaries and work to isolate and secure those systems against unauthorized access and tampering.
M1029	Remote Data Storage	Consider implementing IT disaster recovery plans that contain procedures for taking regular data backups that can be used to restore organizational data. ^[3] Ensure backups are stored off system and is protected from common methods adversaries may use to gain access and manipulate backups.
M1022	Restrict File and Directory Permissions	Ensure least privilege principles are applied to important information resources to reduce exposure to data manipulation risk.

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0059	Detection Strategy for Data Manipulation	AN0162	Correlate unauthorized or anomalous file modifications, deletions, or metadata changes with suspicious process execution or API calls. Detect abnormal changes to structured data (e.g., database files, logs, financial records) outside expected business process activity.
		AN0163	Detect unauthorized manipulation of log files, database entries, or system configuration files through auditd and syslog. Correlate shell commands that alter HISTFILE or data-related processes with abnormal file access patterns.

References

1. [Sygnia Incident Response Team. \(2022, January 5\). TG2003: ELEPHANT BEETLE UNCOVERING AN ORGANIZED FINANCIAL-THEFT OPERATION. Retrieved February 9, 2023.](#)
2. [John Wolfram, Josh Murchie, Matt Lin, Daniel Ainsworth, Robert Wallace, Dimitar Andonov, Dhanesh Kizhakkinan, Jacob Thompson. \(2025, January 8\). Ivanti Connect Secure VPN Targeted in New Zero-Day Exploitation. Retrieved April 14, 2026.](#)
3. [Ready.gov. \(n.d.\). IT Disaster Recovery Plan. Retrieved March 15, 2019.](#)